
2.2 Assessment information

The coursework folder

Coursework folder: 2000-2500 words maximum (including quotations)

80 marks

Two responses are required: an **explorative study** and a **creative critical response**. Tasks should allow students to produce informed, analytical responses which consider playwrights' crafting of the text(s), the ways texts can be compared and the students' own and others' critical response in a creative treatment.

References to texts, sources and quotations must be provided.

It is the centre's responsibility to inform students that there is no tolerance on the prescribed word limit. Students are required to include a cumulative word count at the bottom of each page. Teacher-assessors and moderators will discontinue marking once the prescribed word limit is reached.

Edexcel will provide advice on task setting through training and tutor support materials.

Sample coursework tasks

Example 1

Explorative study

Shakespeare's *King Lear* is studied and Webster's *The White Devil* is used to provide comparison in a study of the tragic hero. Critical reviews of performances are analysed.

Approximate word count: 1800

Creative critical response

Write **TWO** letters to the editor of *The Times Literary Supplement*, one praising a recent performance of *King Lear*; the other criticising it.

Approximate word count: 400

Example 2**Explorative study**

Shakespeare's *Much Ado About Nothing* is studied and Behn's *The Rover* is used to provide comparison in a study of disguise and deception. Critical reviews of performances are analysed.

Approximate word count: 1500

Creative critical response

View a performance for which there are reviews. Write your own review of the performance in which you give your own views and provide a response to the views expressed by others.

Approximate word count: 500

Example 3**Explorative study**

Ford's *'Tis Pity She's a Whore* is studied and Shakespeare's *The Taming of the Shrew* is used to explore the representation of women. Critical reviews of performances are analysed.

Approximate word count: 1750

Creative critical response

Script a talk to peers on two very different interpretations of *'Tis Pity She's a Whore*, making comments on the differences and providing insight into your own critical position.

Approximate word count: 500